UNIVERSIDADE DE SÃO PAULO
*Departamento de Matemática*
INSTITUTO DE MATEMÁTICA E ESTATÍSTICA

November 4, 2007

To whom it may concern:

I am writing to support the application of Benjamin Wilson for a post-doctoral or academic position.

I have known Benjamin since 2003 when he was my Honours student at the University of Sydney. He was awarded the University Medal of the University of Sydney for his Honours dissertation entitled "Lie conformal algebras". In 2004-2007 Benjamin was enrolled in a cotutelle Ph.D. program of the University of Sydney and the University of São Paulo. I was his supervisor on the Brazilian side. Benjamin studied the representations of Kac-Moody Lie algebras, developing a non-standard highest weight theory for affine Lie algebras and current Lie algebras. In particular, he obtained a character formula for exponential-polynomial modules over affine sl(2), amongst other non-trivial results. This was an open problem for quite some time. He had submitted four papers for publication, two of which have already been accepted. In my opinion, the results are strong and very interesting.

During his PhD candidature, Benjamin showed his strong desire for knowledge, capacity for independent study and research. He has a very high potential. Benjamin participated in several conferences and gave talks at the Harish-Chandra Institute (Allahabad, India) and at the International Conference "Algebras, Representations and Applications" (Maresias, Brazil). He was awarded the B.H. Neumann Prize of the Australian Mathematical Society for the most outstanding talk by a postgraduate student at the Annual Meeting of 2006.

I strongly recommend Benjamin Wilson for a post-doctoral or academic position. I believe that he can contribute significantly to the research program of the University.

Sincerely yours,

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